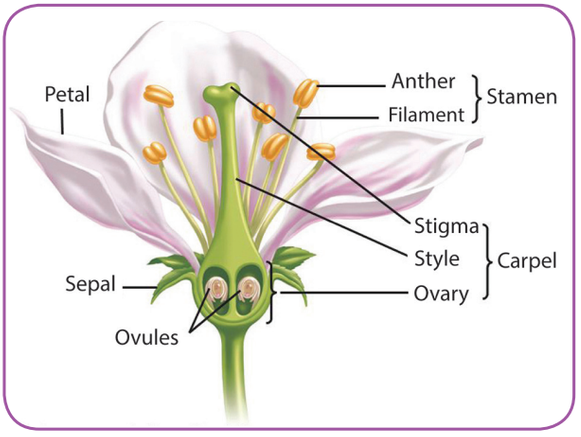
1 Flower

Flower is the reproductive part of a plant. It is a modified shoot. Flowers have four important parts. They are:

- Sepal
- Petal
- Androecium
- Gynoecium



❖ Sepal

It is the outer part of the flower. Usually it is small and green in colour. It protects the bud in the early stage.

❖ Petal

It is often colourful and it attracts the insects.

❖ Androecium

It is the male reproductive part of the flower. It is composed of stamens. Each stamen consists of a stalk called filament and a small bag like structure called anther at the tip. The pollen grains are produced in the anther within the pollen sacs.

❖ Gynoecium

It is the female part of the flower. It has three parts. They are: ovary, style and stigma. The ovary contains the ovules.

The flowers which contain either androecium or gynoecium are called **unisexual flowers**. E.g. Corn, Papaya, Cucumber. The flowers which contain both androecium and gynoecium are called **bisexual flowers**. E.g. Mustard, Rose.



Papaya (Unisexual flower)



Rose (Bisexual flower)

To attract the pollinators (E.g. Insects) plants are bright in colour and produce smell in their flowers. Plants which are pollinated by the honey bees and butterflies have sweet scents and bigger colourful petals. E.g. Sunflower, Pumpkin. Pigments present in petals give them different colours. Plants which are pollinated by the

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